

Jacksonville Village Website

Accessibility Readiness Packet

Supporting Access to Public Information for All Residents

Prepared for: Jacksonville Village, Ohio

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Prepared as part of a cybersecurity practicum experience at Hocking College.

About This Packet

This packet provides guidance to help Jacksonville Village improve and maintain access to information on its website.

The website serves as an important source of public information, including meeting minutes, contact details, and community updates. Making this information easier to access helps residents find services, understand public information, and stay connected.

This document is not a technical or legal report. It is intended to support informed decision-making and provide practical tools for ongoing accessibility improvements.

Why Accessibility Matters

Accessible websites help ensure that all residents can:

- Find important information and services
- Access public documents and meeting materials
- Communicate with village departments
- Stay informed about local updates and announcements

In practice, residents may rely on the website to locate meeting information, find contact details, or review public notices. When information is difficult to read, navigate, or understand, it can limit access for some users.

Improving accessibility helps ensure that public information is available to all residents, supporting clear communication, transparency, and equitable access to services.

What We Noticed

During this review, several issues were identified that may make it harder for some residents to access information:

- Some links are not clearly labeled, making it difficult to understand where they lead
- Some pages contain content that may be hard to read or navigate with assistive tools
- Some public documents are not fully accessible, which may limit access to key information
- The organization of some pages makes it harder to quickly find important content

These issues do not prevent all access, but they may create barriers for some users, particularly those relying on assistive technologies.

Priority Areas for Improvement

Based on how these issues affect access to public information, the following areas should be addressed first:

High Priority

- **Clarify links and navigation** — Ensure links clearly indicate where they lead and support straightforward navigation.
- **Improve accessibility of public documents** — Ensure documents are easy to read, well structured, and usable with assistive technologies.

Medium Priority

- **Improve page layout for easier navigation** — Organize pages so key information is easy to locate and scan.
- **Improve content readability** — Use clear text, sufficient contrast, and structured content to improve understanding.

These priorities focus on the areas most likely to impact access to public information and services.

How to Improve (Non-Technical Guidance)

The following recommendations focus on simple, non-technical changes that can improve access to information across the website.

Improve Navigation and Links

- Use clear, descriptive names for links so users understand where they lead
- Avoid vague labels such as “Click Here” or “More Info”
- Keep navigation simple and consistent across pages

Improve Public Documents

- Use documents that are clearly organized and easy to follow
- Avoid scanned files when possible, as they may not work with assistive tools
- Present information in a logical order so users can follow the content easily

Improve Page Layout

- Keep page layouts simple and consistent
- Place important information where users expect to find it

- Reduce visual clutter that may hide key content

Improve Readability

- Use clear text with good contrast between text and background
- Break content into sections with headings
- Keep text concise and easy to scan

Using the Tools

The tools in this packet are designed to be used in two ways:

- In this document for context and examples
- As separate printouts for day-to-day use

Use the checklist and posting guide during updates, and use the decision guide when deciding what to fix first.

Included tools (also provided separately):

- Accessibility Checklist (Quick Reference)
- Content Posting Guide (Quick Reference)
- Accessibility Decision Guide (Quick Reference)

Tool 1 — Quick Accessibility Checklist

Use this when updating or reviewing the website.

When to use: Before any update and during monthly reviews

Quick Wins

- ☐ Links clearly describe where they go

Example: Use “Pay Water Bill” instead of “Click here”

- ☐ Homepage navigation is easy to understand

Example: Main options are labeled “Directory,” “Minutes,” and “Utilities”

- ☐ Contact information is easy to find

Example: Phone and office names are grouped and labeled clearly

- ☐ Key documents are readable

Example: Meeting minutes open and can be followed top to bottom

Ongoing Content Checks

- ☐ Use clear and simple language

Example: Use “Trash Pickup Schedule” instead of “Sanitation Operations Timeline”

- ☐ Keep layouts consistent

Example: Use the same menu and structure across pages

- ☐ Ensure text is easy to read

Example: Use dark text on a light background

- ☐ Avoid using images as the only way to share information

Example: Do not post a flyer image without also typing the details

When Adding Content

- ☐ Information is clearly organized

Example: Use headings like “Date,” “Location,” and “Agenda”

- ☐ Headings are used to structure content

Example: Break long pages into sections

- ☐ Documents are readable and not scanned images

Example: Upload typed PDFs instead of photos of pages

- ☐ Links use clear, descriptive names

Example: Use “Council Meeting Minutes – March 2026”

Periodic Review

- ☐ Review key pages (homepage, directory, documents)
- ☐ Test how easy it is to find information
- ☐ Update older content as needed

Recommended Frequency

- Monthly: Quick review of homepage and contact information
- Quarterly: Review key pages and documents
- Annually: Review overall site organization and older content

How to Do This Quickly

- Open the homepage and click through the main menu — note anything confusing
- Pick one recent document and read it top to bottom — check if it is easy to follow
- Ask: “Could a first-time visitor find this in under 30 seconds?”

Tool 2 — Content Posting Guide

Use this checklist every time new content or documents are added to the website. **When to use:** Every time new content or documents are added or updated

Before Publishing New Content, Ask

- ☐ Is this information easy to understand?

Example: Would someone unfamiliar with the topic understand this page?

- ☐ Are links clearly labeled?

Example: Use “Water Department Contact” instead of “More Info”

- ☐ Is the content easy to read and organized clearly?

Example: Use short sections instead of one long paragraph

- ☐ Can someone quickly find this later?

Example: Place it under the correct menu and use clear titles

Visual and Hearing Accessibility Checks

- ☐ Is text easy to see?

Example: Use dark text on a light background and avoid faint colors

- ☐ Is important information provided in text (not just images)?

Example: If you post a flyer image, also type the details on the page

- ☐ If audio or video is used, is there a text alternative?

Example: Add captions to videos or a short written summary

- ☐ Are images described clearly in surrounding text?

Example: A photo of a road closure includes a caption explaining the location and dates

How to Do This Quickly

- Read your page out loud — if it sounds confusing, simplify it
- Replace any “click here” links with specific names
- Add a short heading every few paragraphs
- Preview the page and scan it like a new visitor
- Check color contrast by asking: “Is this easy to read at a glance?”
- For any video or audio, add a brief written summary below it

This quick check helps prevent accessibility issues before they occur.

Tool 3 — Decision Guide: What to Fix First

When to use: When planning updates or deciding what to fix next

Step-by-Step Guide

- Step 1: Is this related to important public information?

Example: Contacts, services, and meeting minutes.

Example: a broken link to meeting minutes = YES

- Step 2: Can residents easily access and understand the information?

Examples: “Click here” link text; very faint text; video with no captions

- Step 3: Does this make the website harder or slower to use?

Example: users must scroll past a large banner to find the main content

Priority Levels

- Fix First

Example: Blocks access to important information

- Fix Next

Example: Makes information harder to find or use

- Lower Priority

Example: Minor issues

Quick Triage (30–60 seconds)

- Who is affected?

Example: screen reader users, low vision, or hearing-related needs

- What task is impacted?

Example: Find contact information, read minutes, view announcements

- Where is it on the site?

Example: Homepage, directory, or documents

- How often is it used?

Example: Frequent pages first

Where to Start

- Homepage and main menu
- Contact or directory pages
- Meeting minutes and documents

How to Use This Guide

- Start with the homepage or most-used pages
- Pick one issue at a time and walk through the steps above
- Focus on anything that affects services, contact information, or documents first
- Aim for small fixes you can complete in one session (30–60 minutes)

Start with the most-used pages and focus on one issue at a time.

Ongoing Accessibility Practices

Use the following approach to maintain accessibility over time:

During Regular Updates

- Use the Content Posting Guide each time new content is added or updated

Monthly

- Review the homepage and key navigation areas
- Confirm contact information is easy to find and understand

Quarterly

- Review key pages and documents for readability and clarity
- Check that important information is still easy to locate

Annually

- Review overall site organization
- Update or replace older documents that may be harder to use

Maintaining accessibility is an ongoing process. Small, consistent improvements over time can make a meaningful difference.

Final Note

This review identified opportunities to improve how residents access information on the Jacksonville Village website.

The website is already usable in many areas, and these improvements are intended to enhance access and clarity for all users.

Focusing on the areas identified in this packet will help support better communication, improved usability, and broader access to public information.

Appendix — Quick Reference Visual Tools

- Accessibility Checklist graphic
- Content Posting Guide graphic
- Accessibility Decision Guide graphic
- Combined one-page quick reference graphic (optional)

Accessibility Checklist

Quick Reference – Print and Keep at Your Desk

Basic Access Check

- ☒ Clear, readable text
- ☒ Strong contrast (dark text on light background)
- ☒ Navigation works without confusion



Visual & Hearing Checks

- ☒ No important info only in images
- ☒ Captions or summaries for videos/audio
- ☒ Images described in nearby text



Links & Navigation

- ☒ Links clearly describe where they go
- ☒ Menus are easy to use
- ☒ Pages are easy to scan quickly

Focus on small improvements you can complete in one session.

Content Posting Guide

Use Every Time You Update the Website



Write Clearly

- ▶ Use simple words
- ▶ Keep sentences short
- ▶ Use clear headings



Add Helpful Links

- ▶ Use clear link names
- ▶ Avoid "Click here"
- ▶ Link to the correct page



Include Text Alternatives

- ▶ Add descriptions for images
- ▶ Summarize videos or audio
- ▶ Don't rely on visuals alone



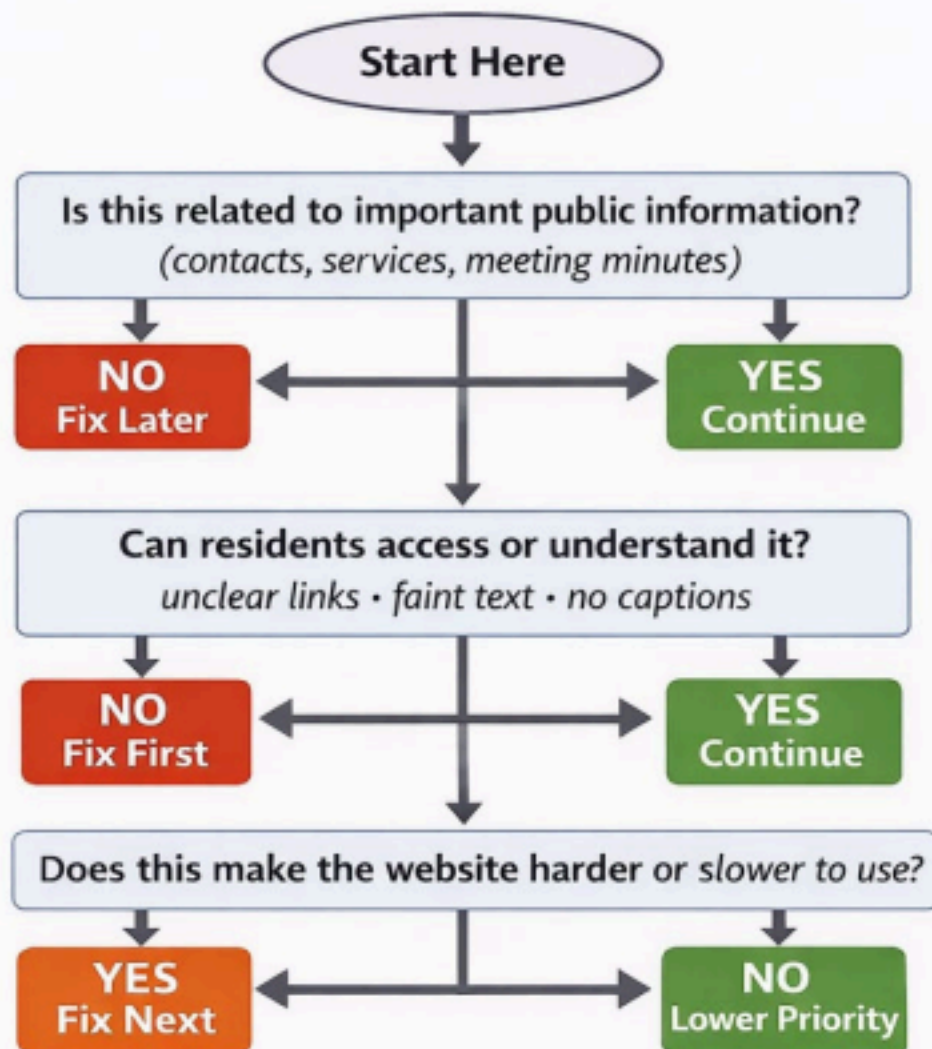
Make It Easy to Read

- ☒ Break content into sections
- ☒ Avoid long paragraphs
- ☒ Use consistent layout

Double-check your work before posting!

Accessibility Decision Guide

Use When Deciding What to Fix First



Priority Guide

- ✓ **Fix First** Blocks access
- ✓ **Fix Next** Slows users
- ✓ **Fix Later** Minor issues

Start with homepage, contact info, and meeting documents.